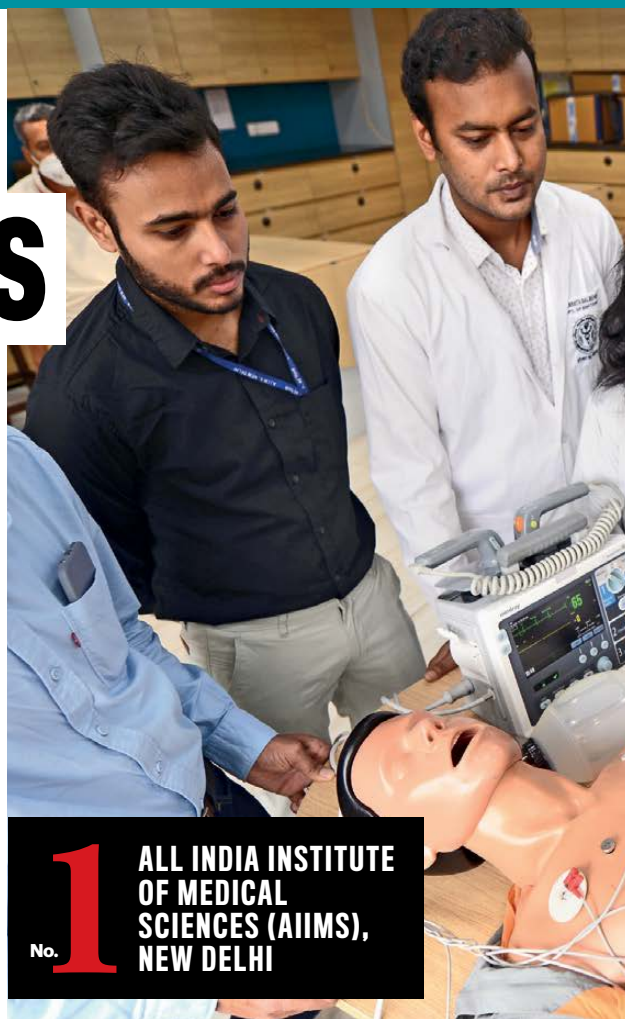
GRANDMASTERS OF MEDICINE

AIIMS Delhi runs ahead of the pack yet again on the strength of close teacher-student ties, the latest in drugs and machinery, quality research and trying out new procedures

BY SONALI ACHARJEE



No. 1 ALL INDIA INSTITUTE OF MEDICAL SCIENCES (AIIMS), NEW DELHI

As a hospital, the All India Institute of Medical Sciences (AIIMS) Delhi treats 80,000 inpatients and 1.5 million outpatients on its 115-acre campus every year. The diversity of both patients and diseases you encounter at AIIMS makes the academic experience here unparalleled, presenting students with endless opportunities to practise their theoretical knowledge. With just over 1,700 medical students distributed across 43 departments, the average student-teacher ratio at AIIMS is estimated to be 6:1, compared to the national average of 29:1. It is this virtuous ratio which allows faculty to develop close ties with students, allowing for deep mentorships and unmatched density of learning inputs. The institute has also always embraced innovation and is usually the first to receive any new technology or medical drug to test. This year, AIIMS Delhi has begun research on using music therapy for speech rehabilitation in stroke survivors and has built AI-based simulators to train and evaluate budding neurosurgeons for minimally invasive microscopic and endoscopic surgical skills. The institute is also considering opening a new course in spirituality medicine.

The interests of its students are always close to the institute's heart. During the ongoing heat wave in Delhi, for instance, the institute took immediate steps to provide extra drinking water facilities. AIIMS Delhi also intends to train all its staff, including security personnel, with emergency CPR (cardio-pulmonary resuscitation) to ensure everyone has a basic minimum awareness on emergency life-saving care. It is this combination of academic excellence, hands-on learning and an atmosphere of warmth and creativity that keeps AIIMS Delhi at the very top of the league of 700-odd medical colleges in India. ■

WHAT SETS IT APART

- AIIMS Delhi is ranked **first in the number of patients** treated per student
- It's ranked first in the **number of research papers** published per faculty member
- It's also top-ranked in the number of **research paper contributions per faculty member to Scopus,** the abstract and citation database